

Asus ROG Xbox Ally X

PC power meets Xbox magic

₹1,15,000



The year was 2005, and Sony's PSP was the ultimate badge of cool. Every kid wanted one. And while some had it, the rest of us could only dream. I was firmly in that second group – the one that admired the PSP from afar. Maybe this is why portable gaming consoles have always fascinated me. When I first tried Asus' ROG Ally back in 2023, the little kid in me who never got the PSP was finally happy. Now, Asus has returned with a new handheld, and this one feels even more special.

Built in collaboration with Xbox, the ROG Xbox Ally X lets you carry your gaming world wherever you want. It's compact, powerful, and built for people who want the Xbox experience wherever they go. I've spent the past week using it as my primary gaming device – in cabs, during lunch breaks, and even when I was down with a heavy fever. And I am happy to say, I'm hooked.

DESIGN AND DISPLAY

The ROG Xbox Ally X comes in a stunning matte black finish. The joysticks have that signature Ally lightning strips and at the back, there is the ROG logo, created from air vents.



The device is compact enough to hold in one hand, although users with smaller palms might find it slightly challenging to get a comfortable grip. Personally, I could carry it around easily, but during long gaming sessions, I did start to feel a bit of fatigue after about an hour. My wrists didn't hurt, but I eventually switched to resting it on my lap or a pillow.

The device comes with Xbox-style controllers attached to a screen. The highlight here is the textured grips, which take heavy inspiration from Xbox controllers. These improve handling drastically and prevent accidental slips.

There is also subtle ROG Xbox branding etched across the surface

which makes the handheld looks neat yet proud of its association with Xbox. The back houses two USB Type-C ports (one for charging), along with a 3.5mm headphone jack. There are also various shortcut buttons that are incredibly useful.

Coming to the display, the ROG Xbox Ally X packs a 7-inch 1080p IPS display that lets you get immersed in your games. It's a bit reflective under strong light, but nothing too concerning.

Colours appear natural and well-balanced, without the oversaturation that plagues some gaming devices. It's also bright enough for outdoor or on-the-move play as I enjoyed many quick sessions in a cab after work without any issues. However, dust and fingerprints form on the screen quite easily. Moreover, in this price segment, I would have loved it if an OLED option was also present.

BATTERY AND SPEAKERS

Coming to the battery life, it is satisfactory given the kind of hardware this console is pushing. While gaming, the handheld lasted for around 2-3 hours. For instance, I started playing Forza Horizon 5 on the device with 57% battery. After half an hour, the battery dropped to 36%. Another 20 minutes later, the battery was hovering around 20%. Thus, the ROG Xbox Ally X seems built for bursts of intense gaming rather than long unplugged marathons. And that's expected for a device that runs full-fledged PC titles.

Meanwhile, when I used Windows Edge browser and YouTube on the

